

Ivan Yuri “Lion” P. De Leon

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EDUCATION

Ateneo de Manila University

Master in Data Science

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2026

- Graduate Assistant – Mathematics Department & Environmental Science Department
- *Coursework:* Deep Learning, Computer Vision, Bayesian Techniques, Time Series Forecasting, Big Data Systems

Ateneo de Manila University

BS in Applied Mathematics (Data Science), Minor in Economics

Quezon City, Philippines

May 2025

- **Summa Cum Laude;** Mulry Award for Literary Excellence; University Academic Scholar (Full Tuition Scholarship)
- **Managing Editor & Finance Officer,** HEIGHTS Ateneo (official literary & artistic publication)
- *Coursework:* Graph Theory, Operations Research, Business Intelligence, Financial Economics, Seminar on Finance, Linguistics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ayala Corporation

Data Analytics and AI Intern

Makati, Philippines

Apr 2025 - Sept 2025

- Led a cross-functional initiative with Ayala Corp and AC Mobility teams, developing predictive models to identify key car sales drivers, informing a promo-effectiveness metric and improving sales forecasting.
- Conducted attrition and leave analysis for 200+ employees and automated workforce analytics reporting by developing a real-time HR dashboard, reducing report generation time from monthly to instant.
- Modeled user behavior for 5,000+ early adopters in a mobility app using Markov chains, which guided feature prioritization.
- Supported data engineering processes, including large-scale querying, preprocessing, and quality control.

Bank of the Philippine Islands

Data Science Intern

Makati, Philippines

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Delivered 4 finance-focused data projects, covering market data scraping, product recommendation systems, customer segmentation for tailored service delivery, and explainable AI for credit risk modeling.
- **Finalist (3/20 teams)** in a case competition across multiple companies under the Ayala conglomerate, collaborating with five senior leaders to design an innovation-driven solution impacting 10,000+ employees.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

TARA Program

AI Alignment Participant

Quezon City, Philippines

Mar 2026 - Jun 2026

- Selected for an APAC AI Alignment training program (Philippines, Singapore, Japan, and Australia), covering transformers, mechanistic interpretability, reinforcement learning, LLM evaluation, and AI agents.
- Developed two research capstones in two weeks: (1) [jailbreaking attacks](#) using 2,600 multilingual prompts across 4 LLMs, identifying a 62% jailbreak success rate in Tagalog vs. lower rates in English; (2) [mechanistic interpretability](#) of multi-agent LLM systems across 8 scenarios with Sydney-based collaborators (**Rank 9/40 projects**)

Nara Institute of Science and Technology

Human-AI Interaction Lab Intern

Nara, Japan

Jan 2026

- Developed a 500-image [multimodal benchmark](#) evaluating cultural heritage recognition across OpenAI and Google VLMs, using an automated LLM-judge scoring pipeline. On track to O-COCOSDA 2026.

PROJECTS

[\[Portfolio Website\]](#)

Graph-Based Analysis of Customer-Merchant Payment Networks

Master's Capstone

- Independently designed a customer-merchant affinity metric in collaboration with BPI, applying community detection and graph neural networks across 4.4M transactions to surface the behavioral pattern of the bank's wealthiest customer segment.
- Identified 18 customers likely to belong to BPI's high-value segment and 20 merchants associated with that segment's preferences.

BEA: Blue Eagle Assistant

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Slides\]](#) [\[Video\]](#)

- Built a 6-agent RAG-powered chatbot using LangGraph and Streamlit, orchestrating specialized agents to answer student queries on handbook references, university policies, and contacts.

Volatility Modeling on the USD-PHP Exchange Rate using ARMA-GARCH Models

[\[Repo\]](#) [\[Paper\]](#)

- Modeled one year of daily USD-PHP exchange rates (Jul 2024–Jul 2025) using ARIMA-GARCH, forecasting continued peso depreciation with widening uncertainty bands, amid a historic low of PHP 59/USD.

PUBLICATIONS

PACUTE: Phonology-, Affix-, and Character-level Understanding of Tokens for Filipino

[\[Preprint\]](#)

- Developed a diagnostic benchmark of 4,600 tasks for morphological understanding in Filipino, covering infixation, reduplication, and diacritic-driven distinctions that standard tokenizers fail to capture. Submitted to EMNLP 2026.

OTHER DETAILS

- **Tools:** Python (Scikit-learn, PyTorch), R, SQL, Power BI, Apache Spark, Hadoop, GCP, Java, Git, Django, Streamlit
- **Data Skills:** NLP, Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Network Analysis, Time Series, Big Data Processing, Web Scraping
- **Advocacy:** AI Safety (Participant on [TARA](#), [BlueDot Impact](#), & [AISD](#)); Filipino Intellectualization (Research on Filipino LLMs)